STORY · LESSON 4

Where Were You, Adam?

Adam was not in class yesterday. Read the story in the past, then read it again as it happens today.

Talk about yesterday | Ask: Where were you? | Say where you were

1 The story

Yesterday **was** Monday. Sara and Omar **were** in class, but Adam **wasn't** there. His chair **was** empty. Mr. Ali **was** surprised, because Adam is never absent.

In the evening, Omar **was** on the phone with Adam. "Where **were** you today, Adam? **Were** you sick?" "No, I **wasn't**. I **was** at the hospital with my grandfather. He **was** sick."

"Oh no! **Was** it bad?" "Yes, it **was**. We **were** at the hospital all day. My mother and my uncle **were** there, too. The doctors **were** very kind."

Today Adam is back in class. His grandfather is at home now, and he is OK. "Welcome back, Adam!" Sara and Omar are happy, and Mr. Ali is happy, too.

2 Questions and answers

Answer fast. Short answers are fine.

1 **Was yesterday Monday?**
Yes, it was.

2 **Were Sara and Omar in class?**
Yes, they were.

3 **Was Adam in class?**
No, he wasn't.

4 **Was his chair empty?**
Yes, it was.

5 **Was Mr. Ali surprised or happy?**
Surprised. Adam is never absent.

6 **Where was Omar in the evening?**
On the phone with Adam.

7 **Was Adam sick?**
No, he wasn't.

8 **Where was Adam?**
At the hospital.

9 **Who was sick?**
His grandfather.

10 **Were they at the hospital all day?**
Yes, they were.

11 **Were the doctors kind?**
Yes, they were. They were very kind.

12 **Where is his grandfather now?**
At home. He's OK now.

Where Were You, Adam? (continued)

3 Point of view

Now the same story happens today.

Today is Monday. Sara and I are in class, but Adam isn't here. His chair is empty. Mr. Ali is surprised, because Adam is never absent.

In the evening, I'm on the phone with Adam. "Where are you, Adam? Are you sick?" "No, I'm not. I'm at the hospital with my grandfather. He is sick."

"Oh no! Is it bad?" "Yes, it is. We are here all day. My mother and my uncle are here, too. The doctors are very kind."

4 What did you learn?

You learned was and were.

They are the past of am, is and are. We use them for yesterday, last week, and other times before now.

NOW	BEFORE NOW
I am at home. · He is sick.	I was at home. · He was sick.
We are at the hospital.	We were at the hospital.
He isn't here. · They aren't here.	He wasn't here. · They weren't here.
Is it bad? · Are you sick?	Was it bad? · Were you sick?

I · he · she · it → was
I was at home. It was bad.

you · we · they → were
We were at the hospital all day.

Not: wasn't · weren't
Adam wasn't in class. They weren't at home.

QUESTIONS **Were you in class yesterday?** Yes, I was. / No, I wasn't.

5 New words

yesterday	the day before today	**empty**	with nothing and no one in it
surprised	feeling that something is not what you expected	**absent**	not here; not at school or work
all day	from morning to evening	**back**	here again